



WEEK FOUR · MODULE FOUR

# Your Anticipation Playbook

*The deliverable of Week Four*

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THE PRIVATE CONCIERGE ACADEMY

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**HOW TO STUDY THIS MODULE**

This is the first document of the programme that you will actually use in a house, from your first week.

It is a working instrument, not an essay. If it is beautiful and you never open it, it has failed.

Four pages. No more. A playbook nobody reads is a decoration.

## CHAPTER I

# What you are producing

*A working instrument*

**LEARNING OBJECTIVES**

Understand what the playbook is for.

The playbook is the document you open on your first morning in a new household, and again at the end of your first week, and again after your first mistake. It is the written form of your own method, in your own words, and by the end of the programme it will be one of the most valuable things you own.

It has four pages and five sections. It is written for a reader who is tired, in a hurry, and slightly frightened. That reader is you, in month one.

## CHAPTER II

# Section by section

*What goes in each*

**LEARNING OBJECTIVES**

Build each section correctly.

| Section                               | What it contains                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 · My observation system             | Your six categories, written as questions you will ask yourself every evening. The time of day you will do it. Where the log will live. Be specific: "22:00, in the black notebook, before I put the telephone away." Vague systems are not systems.                 |
| 2 · The preference file: my structure | Your blank template, ready to be filled on day one. Every field you will collect, in order. And, written at the top of it, the five things that must never appear in it.                                                                                             |
| 3 · My anticipation loop              | The four movements, in your own words, with one line each on how you personally will fail at each of them. You know your own weaknesses. Write them down where you will see them.                                                                                    |
| 4 · My thresholds and my asks         | The list of situations in which you will always ask, without exception. This is the section that will keep you employed. Write it as commands, not as principles: "I always ask before anything irreversible." Not: "irreversibility is an important consideration." |
| 5 · My pre-mortem checklist           | The five to eight questions you will run before anything that matters. Yours, not mine. If it does not sound like you, you will not use it.                                                                                                                          |

## CHAPTER III

# The template

*The shape of the document*

**LEARNING OBJECTIVES**

Follow the structure.

**PAGE ONE**

**My observation system.** The six categories as six questions. The hour. The place. The rule: facts only, never "seemed", never "felt".

**PAGE TWO**

**The preference file.** Your blank structure, field by field, ready to use. And the five prohibitions at the head of it, in bold.

**PAGE THREE**

**The loop, and my thresholds.** Observe, infer, prepare, withdraw, each with the sentence "the way I will get this wrong is...". Then the list of things you will always ask about, written as commands.

**PAGE FOUR**

**The pre-mortem.** Your questions. And, at the foot of the page, the three sentences you will say when you have made an error: the fact, the fix, the ownership. Written out in full, so that you do not have to compose them on the worst morning of your year.

## CHAPTER IV

# How it will be judged

*Honestly, and against the standard of the profession*

**LEARNING OBJECTIVES**

Understand what a weak playbook looks like, so that you do not write one.

**What I am looking for****What that means**

|                            |                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Specificity                | "I will observe carefully" is worth nothing. "22:00, six categories, black notebook, facts only" is worth something. Every line of this document should be executable by a tired person. |
| Your own weaknesses, named | Section 3 asks you to write down how you will personally fail. If you have written something flattering there, you have wasted the exercise and I will say so.                           |
| The asks                   | If your threshold list is short, or vague, or noble rather than specific, you have not understood Chapter IX of Module I, and that is the chapter that keeps people employed.            |
| Usability                  | Four pages. Could you find the right line in fifteen seconds, at seven in the morning, in a house you do not know? If not, rewrite it.                                                   |

## CHAPTER V

# Submission

**LEARNING OBJECTIVES**

Submit correctly.

Four pages. PDF. Submitted before your session, together with your seven-day observation log and your question count.

Then use it. Open it on your first morning in a house. Revise it at the end of your first month, and again at the end of your first year, and it will be a different document by then, and that is exactly what should happen. **The playbook you graduate with is not the playbook you will retire with, and the difference between them is your career.**

**HOW TO SUBMIT, AND HOW TO BOOK YOUR SESSION**

1. **Submit.** Everything you produced this week goes into the **Submit** area of **Module 4**, inside your student portal. One PDF. Not by email, and not in the chat.
2. **Book.** The moment your work is uploaded, a **Book your session** button appears in that same place. Click it and choose your slot with me. Do it straight away, while you are there, because the slots for each week are limited and they are taken in the order they are booked.
3. **Leave me time.** Book your session for at least **two days after your submission**, so that I can read your work properly beforehand. That way the session is spent on the correction rather than on the reading, and you get every minute of it.

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